1.4.1. A little story about language

Sometime around the fifth century, a West Germanic tribe invaded Britain and brought with them their language. As a result, the existing languages of the region (Celtic and Cornish) were mostly replaced with the West Germanic dialect of the invaders, leaving only a hint of Celtic and Cornish in modern English today. A few hundred years later some Vikings, who spoke a Scandinavian language, colonized parts of Northern Britain. They needed to speak the local language (now a West Germanic dialect) in order to trade with nearby people, but they didn't know it very well, so they spoke a simplified, broken version of it. The broken way they spoke the language changed the way everybody else spoke it, the language evolved as a result.

Later, in the eleventh century, the Norman French conquered England, and William the Conqueror became the king of England. During the Norman occupancy the official language of the region was Norman French, but English was still spoken by the commoners on the streets and on their farms. This is why English farm animals such as cows and pigs have one name, but the meats used in the restaurants by people speaking Norman French have other names such as beef and pork. The entire history of English is like this. When the printing press was invented, it had only the Latin alphabet, so English was changed again, one of the changes being to replace the thorn, þ, with the digraph th.

Now, you *might* think that a community doesn't shape a constructed programming language like JavaScript in the same way it shapes a spoken language like English, but a language that isn't shaped by a community is a dead language. A language can initially be constructed, but eventually it either evolves and changes as part of a community or it perishes. Just consider any one of the thousands of constructed spoken languages created in the history of mankind. Even Esperanto, perhaps the best-known constructed language, has today fewer than 1,000 native speakers.

1.4.2. The lesson for JavaScript